

Monthly Budget Worksheet

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A working budget for the month. The shape of it is set by two large fixed costs, rent and the student loan, with everything else fit around them. Grace keeps a careful eye on the numbers, pays all balances in full, and protects a small but steady contribution to savings.

Income

Salary, monthly net About \$4,250.00

Quilting, monthly average About \$415.00

Planned Expenses

Category	Detail	Amount
Rent	Upper duplex, Westcott	\$1,100.00
Student loan	Standard payment	\$870.00
Insurance and health	Health, auto	\$440.00
Groceries and dining	Co-op and dining out	\$470.00
Grandmother support	Groceries and prescriptions	\$150.00
Other	Utilities, phone, supplies, therapy	\$565.00
Savings	Emergency fund	\$200.00

Notes

The grandmother support line covers groceries and prescriptions for Grandma Ruth on the family farm in Malone, a non negotiable that Grace builds in before anything discretionary. The other line gathers utilities, phone, quilting supplies, and the biweekly therapy copay that has helped her manage the stress of public interest work.

The emergency fund receives two hundred dollars a month and is building toward a fifteen thousand dollar cushion. The current balance is eighty five hundred. It is slow going alongside the loan, but it is steady, which is how Grace prefers to do most things.